

Pseudo-Jerome: *On the Heresies of the Jews* (*De haeresibus Judaeorum*)

English translation by Luke J. Stevens, 2023

Translation

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| 1. Essenes | 6. Genists |
| 2. Galileans | 7. Merists |
| 3. Marboneans | 8. Samaritans |
| 4. Pharisees | 9. Herodians |
| 5. Sadducees | 10. Hemerobaptists |

1. The Essenes say that the Christ taught them every kind of abstinence.
2. The Galileans say that the Christ came and taught them not to call Caesar “lord” nor to use his money.
3. The Marboneans say that it was the Christ himself who taught them to keep the Sabbath in everything.
4. The Pharisees deny that the Christ has come and share none of the aforementioned matters.
5. The Sadducees deny the resurrection, saying that it was said in Genesis to Adam: *You are earth, and into earth you will go.*
6. The Genists presume, since they are of the lineage of Abraham.
7. The Merists divide the Scriptures, not believing all the prophets, saying that those prophesied by some spirits and by others.

Cf. Jos. *Bell.* 2.119–61, *Ant.* 18.18–22; Philo, *Prob.* 75–91; Hipp. *Ref.* 9.18.3–28.2; Epiph. *Pan.* 10; Filast. *Haer.* 9.

Cf. Jos. *Ant.* 18.23–25; Hipp. *Ref.* 9.26.1–3.

Cf. Heges. ap. Eus. *H.e.* 4.22.5–7 (*Masbotheans*).

Cf. Jos. *Bell.* 2.162–63, *Ant.* 18.12–15; Just. *Dial.* 80.4; Heges. ap. Eus. *H.e.* 4.22.7; Hipp. *Ref.* 9.28.3–5; Ps.-Tert. *Haer.* 1.1; Epiph. *Pan.* 16; Filast. *Haer.* 6.

Gen 3:19 (Vet. Lat.). Cf. Mt 22:23, etc.; Acts 23:8. Cf. Jos. *Bell.* 2.164–65, *Ant.* 18.16–17; Just. *Dial.* 80.4; Heges. ap. Eus. *H.e.* 4.22.7; Hipp. *Ref.* 9.29; Ps.-Tert. *Haer.* 1.1; Epiph. *Pan.* 14; Filast. *Haer.* 5.

Cf. Just. *Dial.* 80.4.

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| <p>8. The <i>Samaritans</i>, who, when Israel was captured and brought to Babylon, were transferred in its place, coming into the land of the kingdom of Samaria. They keep partly the custom of the Israelites, which they learned through a priest brought back, partly the gentile one that they had in the land of their birth. For in their public prayers, they are entirely separated from the Jews. Their superstition is undoubtedly known to all.</p> | <p>Cf. 2 Kgs 17; Jos. <i>Ant.</i> 10.184; Heges. ap. Eus. <i>H.e.</i> 4.22.7; Hipp. <i>Ref.</i> 9.29.4; Epiph. <i>Pan.</i> 9; Filast. <i>Haer.</i> 7.</p> |
| <p>9. The <i>Herodians</i>—in the Savior’s times this heresy arose. These extolled Herod, saying that he was the Christ.</p> | <p>Cf. Mt 22:16; Mk 3:6, 12:13. Cf. Ps.-Tert. <i>Haer.</i> 1.1; Epiph. <i>Pan.</i> 20; Filast. <i>Haer.</i> 28.</p> |
| <p>10. The <i>Hemerobaptists</i>, who daily wash their bodies, homes, and goods. They say that man would not have died if he had not gone out to work.</p> | <p>Cf. perhaps Gen 3:23. Cf. Just. <i>Dial.</i> 80.4 (<i>Baptists</i>); Heges. ap. Eus. <i>H.e.</i> 4.22.7; Ps.-Clem. <i>Hom.</i> 2.23; Epiph. <i>Pan.</i> 17.</p> |

Notes

The critical edition, along with German translation, is given in Niclas Förster, *Jesus und die Steuerfrage: die Zinsgroschenperikope auf dem religiösen und politischen Hintergrund ihrer Zeit*, WUNT 1/294 (Tübingen: Mohr Siebeck, 2012), 291–94. Although the editor struggles to transcribe the final sentence, added in another hand, it is legible in the image ([online](#)) and even given in the manuscript’s [catalogue](#) (*Hii dicunt hominem non moriturum si non ad opera egressus fuisset*). The present text has also been incorporated with modifications in Isid. *Etym.* 8.4. Previous editors have presented this catalogue as the opening of the *Indiculum de haeresibus*, which is adjacent in the manuscripts, but it is doubtful that the two complementary heresy catalogues originated as a unity.

Parallels are noted above in the ancient heresiological tradition, whose precise relation to the present text remains unclear. Derivation from Hegesippus’s lost *Hypomnemata* is the likeliest hypothesis, as Förster argues. On the sects described by Josephus, the literature is abundant, but on the more obscure ones, see L. Calista Olds, “Pre-Christian Sects in Palestinian Judaism: A Critical Examination of the Ancient Sources with Special Emphasis on the Minor Sects” (PhD diss., University of St. Andrews, 1960), available [online](#).